

Designer of three of the most used online public services:
NHS 111, Tax your vehicle, and Check MOT history, each
with tens of millions of users.

Most recently I was a contract interaction designer with Defra /
Environment agency, and before that I was at the NHS as interaction
designer with the product team on the 111 online service.

Through COVID and the aftermath it was a hectic and demanding role.
That was my second tour of duty with NHS Digital, and right before that I
was designing a mobile app for start-up crowdfunder Seedrs.

Previously I worked on a range of innovation projects at Telefonica Digital
covering mobile, internet of things, retail and other curious subjects. I've
also done a range of design roles at startups and larger organisations.

With my own startups, Artfinder and Tioti.com, I was co-founder and took
an idea from sketch through prototype, into production through launch and
beyond. Both receiving angel round funding at first, following up with a
successful series A VC funded round. Tioti was acquired by Vizimo in 2008,
Artfinder continues today.

GOV.UK, GDS and NHS digital experience, also open to designing non-gov
related products, services and also music tech / startup curious.

Makes prototypes: I prefer making things to drawing pictures of things.
Variety over specialism. Quick and dirty over finished and polished. Learn.
Repeat. Learn. Repeat. This is what Design means in agile.

Skills

All to an expert level, 20+ years experience

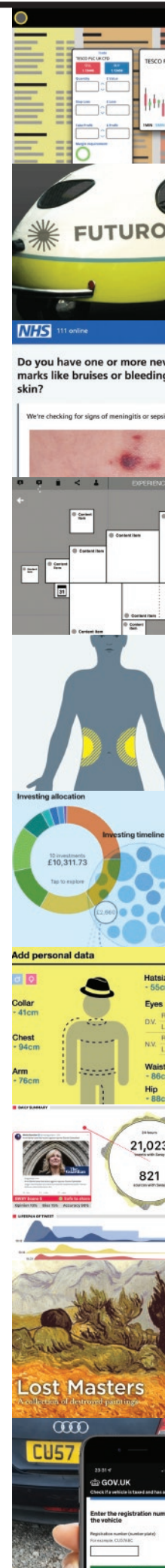
- Interaction design: graphic design, prototyping
- User research: conducting and analysing
- Software development: HTML, CSS, Javascript, GPT
- Design software: Adobe Suite, Figma, Miro, Mural, 3D and video editing

Education

1992 – 1995 : Staffordshire University
BA (hons) Design - Electronic Media

1990 – 1992 : Blackpool & Fylde College
BTEC National Diploma Design - Graphic Design

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/paulpod/>
email paulpod@mac.com
portfolio <http://sp1.me>
phone +44 771 872 4329



February 2026 – July 2026 : HM Courts Tribunal Service

Working as Interaction Designer I helped TransformUK deliver design for new services that support the Renters Rights legislation

- Designing in code: building prototypes for user research
- Case worker systems, citizen facing forms, notifications and dynamic content
- New UI and userflows to process applications for

September 2024 – October 2025 : Defra / Environment Agency

Design for water licensing.

Working as Interaction Designer I joined the WRLS team in September 2024. The initial brief was to design a replacement for an existing 1990s database frontend with a more modern GOV.UK service, redesigning data entry into a more user friendly process that won't require months of training to use correctly.

This was followed by designing a way for users of the existing online Licensing Service to investigate previous versions of licences, tracing changes across the history of a water resource.

- Designing in code: building prototypes for user research
- Working on a speculative pitch to replace the entire end-to-end wider licensing system
- New UI and userflows to investigate history, changes and versions of licences
- Improving the overall service with new navigation

September 2020 – September 2024 : NHS 111 Online

Design for urgent and emergency healthcare in a pandemic.

As Interaction Designer I joined the 111 online team in September 2020, the COVID-19 pandemic in full flow. My initial job was to add booking functionality for patients requiring an A&E visit, with all the complications that can raise. As a new concept for people to understand, it was thoroughly prototyped and researched with users.

Following that I worked on frequent improvements to the 111 online service as the pandemic progressed - from alerts around mink, travellers from Denmark, using pulse oximeters on "virtual wards", through information about vaccines and vaccination side effects. By 2023 we worked on returning the 111 online service to business as normal, with new features. In this role I mentored young designers and contributed to the NHS design system.

- Adapting 111 online to apply the NHS design system
- Adding images, sounds and video to improve triage questions
- Updating user flows to detect, ask and confirm location
- Improving less urgent outcomes: dentists, opticians, midwifery
- Designing ways to deliberately and very vaguely tell people about callback times
- Better ways to let people tell us their location
- Sorting out edge cases around showing accurate opening and closing times
- Improving access to mental health services

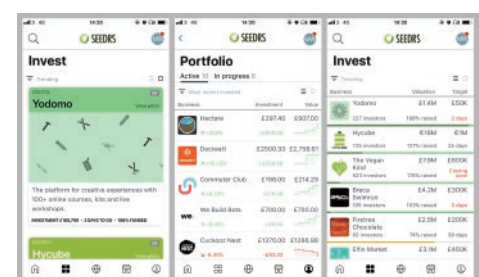
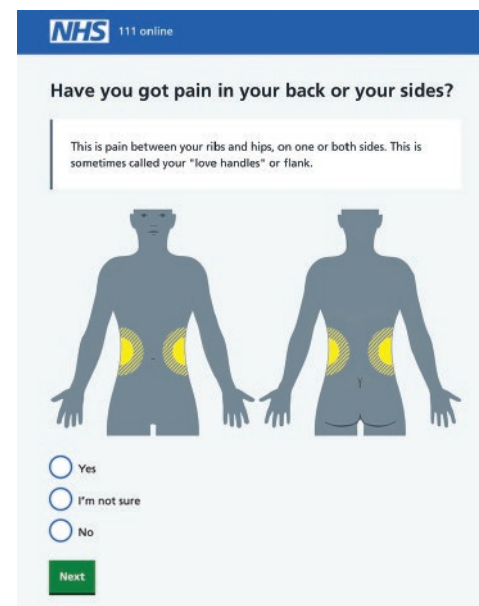
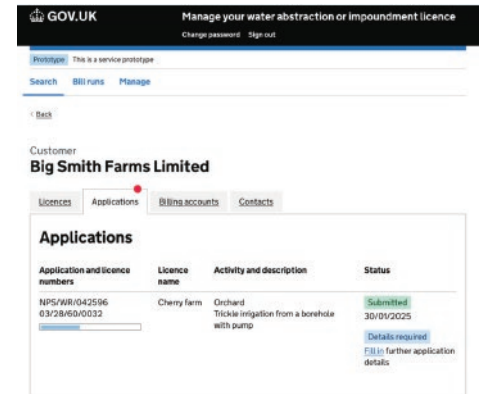
In addition, I spent most of 2023 working on a more inclusive way to ask people their sex before starting a triage. Fascinating work with deep user research.

June 2019 – April 2020: Seedrs

Digital product design for a mobile app.

As Interaction Designer I mostly worked on designing a mobile app for Seedrs users. I've used Framer X to make a number of high fidelity, deep prototypes as well as conducting user research to design the right thing.

- Contributing towards a design system for Seedrs
- Redesigning and simplifying the payment flows
- Reworking a login flow more appropriate for mobile native users
- Mentoring younger designers



September 2017 – June 2019: NHS Digital

Interaction designer & prototyping data orientated products to direct urgent and emergency care patients to appropriate services.

- Built and launched Profile Updater (fixing data about services)
- Built and launched Service Finder (clinical users searching for services)
- Applying NHS/GOV.UK design guidelines as appropriate
- User research with a range of healthcare professionals
- Prototyping using toolkits : NodeJS, JQuery, SASS, etc

Things: I worked in multidisciplinary teams that deliver live products to real users - Paramedics and Pharmacists, 999 and 111 operators.

May 2017 – September 2017: Department for International Trade / Methods

As the Lead Designer I worked on a part of the GREAT campaign website that was intended to handle enquiries about inward investment. Unfortunately due to the realities around Brexit, there were few user needs we could actually meet, so the project was cancelled.

- Applying deep user research to personas, segmentation
- Prototyping using toolkits : NodeJS, SASS, HTML, CSS

October 2016 – December 2016: Fjord + Unilever

As Digital Product Designer I worked on a small innovation project to prototype a chatbot to relieve pressure on HR teams attending to frequently asked questions and tasks for employees.

- Flows and scripts for chatbot interaction
- Prototyping using PullString, Skype Bots, Messenger Bots

February 2016 – August 2016: Gain Capital / City Index

As the Lead Designer I was brought in to kickstart a dramatic refresh of retail trading platforms.

The existing flash-based platform had an end of life on the horizon, and moving to a new HTML5 technology stack provided the opportunity to bring user-centred design principles to the problem.

I made a Gain Capital design guide, user research hub and prototyping kit. We explored and prototyped a range of trading interfaces, covering expert to beginner levels of experience.

- Applying deep user research to personas, segmentation
- Create new design guidelines
- Helping improve internal design capability
- Prototyping using toolkits : NodeJS, JQuery, HTML, CSS

July 2014 – December 2015 : GDS / Head of Design DVLA

Providing central government design support to the Drivers & Vehicles agency – interaction and content design, enforcing guidelines, guiding internal teams.

As the Head of Design my brief was to help teams at the DVLA in Swansea create and improve world-class digital public services. As well as an overall design leadership role, I was lead designer on the popular Tax your vehicle service.

- Helping with content design: less is usually more
- Lead designer on Tax your vehicle
- Apply & adapt design guidelines and best practice
- Helping build internal design capability
- Prototyping using GOVUK toolkits : NodeJS, SASS, HTML, CSS
- Mentoring and training civil servants into interaction designers

Earlier experience includes:

January 2014 – June 2014 : Telefonica Digital / Instore Digital retail

Retail solutions - iBeacons, iOS Passbook and Google Wallets as part of product strategy and development.

January 2013 – December 2013 : Telefonica Digital / Digital Lab

Collaborating as part of a mostly technical team on internal innovation projects. Integrated Android with physical interface using IOIO boards, and other projects.

October 2012 - December 2012 : Lab Guru / Biodata

Complete visual and ux overhaul for a growing startup creating collaborative tools for labs.

May 2012 - September 2012 : Money Advice Service

Created a strategy and vision video, prototyping and explaining future concepts for board level discussion, a digital brand guide, consumer facing information videos for financial concepts.

September 2010 - June 2012 : Artfinder

Co-founder and VP for product and design I helped launch an ambitious digital media project. We grew our site, launched a dozen iPad apps as well as our unique iPhone app with image recognition.

- Hiring the first designers and product managers
- Creating the initial concepts
- Taking the idea from zero to one, and live
- Securing seed and first round VC funding as part of the founding team
- Launching the website, apps and ebooks across multiple platforms

December 2009 - September 2010 : EMI Music

Future product development - new digital products to fulfill a product line better catering to music fans.

January 2009 - December 2009 : Freelance Designer

BBC & BERG: Design and interactive flash prototype of crowdsourced space archeology game.

Plink: Startup turning Oxford University computer vision research into mobile app, acquired by Google April 2010.

Microsoft: Future concepts for audio/visual products with industrial design agency Native.

The Incidental: Design, CSS for British Council at Milan Design Fair with design agency BERG.

October 2005 - December 2008 : Tioti.com

Founder, designer and CEO of web 2.0 startup 'Tape It Off The Internet' a social network and guide for online TV.

Tioti successfully raised VC funding and launched in 2007 and was acquired by Vizimo in 2008

March 2006 - October 2006 : Aggregator.tv

User experience lead for online TV startup.

March 2006 - June 2006 : Poke/Zopa.com

Lead designer on award winning Zopa, social lending and investment site with digital agency Poke.

January 2004 - December 2006 : Neuromantics

Partner and creative director of a small independent digital design agency: visual strategy and prototyping for cutting edge new media applications, specifically IPTV, mobile, podcasting and social media. Clients included BBC, FHM, Nokia, Vodafone and Skype.